

UPDATE:



Appendix A

Planning Process & Administration

APPENDIX A — Planning Process & Administration

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Long-Range Planning and DVRPC

The *Update: Connections 2050 Plan for Greater Philadelphia* (*Update: Connections 2050*, Long-Range Plan, or Plan) outlines a long-range vision and goals and identifies strategies for the future growth of the Greater Philadelphia region. The Plan consists of a summary document and seven appendices, all of which are published via a website hosted at www.dvrpc.org. This Plan was adopted by the DVRPC Board on September 25, 2025, and serves as an update to the previous Long-Range Plan, *Connections 2050: Plan for Greater Philadelphia*.

The Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission (DVRPC) is the federally designated Metropolitan Planning Organization (MPO) for the nine-county Greater Philadelphia region, tasked with developing a long-range transportation plan to ensure the orderly growth and development of the region in concert with multiple planning partners. DVRPC serves a complex mosaic of 350 diverse cities, boroughs, and townships. It includes the nation's sixth largest city, a wide range of suburban areas dotted with historic towns and boroughs that developed around transit, and rural and agricultural areas. Each of these communities have different levels of resources and capabilities to implement the Plan.

DVRPC is governed by an 18-member board, composed of state, county, and city representatives from its member governments, as well as various participating, non-voting members and federal agency observers.

What's New in This Plan Update

This updated Long-Range Plan reflects significant revisions across its goals, strategies, structure, and content. Many of these changes stem directly from input received through public outreach, along with evolving regional needs and planning best practices. The Plan's visioning outreach served as a check on the vision and goals in the *Connections 2050* Plan, rather than starting this engagement with a blank slate, as has been done in all recent update cycles.

The Plan updates the goals and strategies for the core elements—transportation, economy, communities, and environment—to incorporate public priorities. In addition, this update introduces a new plan element: infrastructure and utility services. Each plan element is now accompanied by a set of goals and detailed strategy recommendations. To promote transparency and accountability, the Plan identifies the party or parties responsible for implementing each recommendation.

The Plan also includes a full revision of Plan Centers—locations best suited to accommodate growth and development—shifting to a more quantitative and spatially grounded approach. The updated methodology emphasizes places with existing density and transit access and encourages future growth near existing transit infrastructure. The Centers are organized into five typologies, each of which features targeted strategy recommendations. Enhanced messaging spotlights select City and Town Centers as model examples of context-sensitive, transit-supportive development.

The financial plan includes several notable changes. A new project category for substantive safety improvements has been created and is nearly fully funded, in alignment with the Plan's Vision Zero goal of eliminating traffic deaths and serious injuries by 2050. Additionally, the Plan introduces a new green transportation category that bundles bicycle and pedestrian projects with environmental and regional planning investments. Notably, the Regional Circuit Trail Network is now fully funded in this category.

To improve clarity and usability, transit projects have been reorganized into four distinct categories in alignment with asset management databases used by partner transit agencies:

- Preservation and Modernization
- Operational Improvements
- System Expansion
- Other

The Plan also undertook a full review of the Major Regional Project (MRP) list, ensuring consistency, feasibility, and alignment with regional goals. Sponsors were required to resubmit any candidate projects not funded for construction in the first four years of the current Transportation Improvement

Program (TIP), effectively refreshing the list and reinforcing project readiness.

To enhance transparency, the financial plan now includes a full funding breakdown by project category for each MRP, providing greater clarity on how regional transportation dollars are allocated. Additionally, DVRPC has made past long-range plans, updates, and adopted amendments publicly available online at www.dvrpc.org/plan/planhistory, offering an accessible record of how long-range planning has evolved.

Together, these changes position the updated Long-Range Plan to better reflect regional priorities, align with current federal guidance, and support a more accountable, resilient, and collaborative planning process.

Process Overview

The development of *Update: Connections 2050* followed an integrated planning process based on collaborative planning theory.¹ The process includes five key steps (see Figure A-1):

- *Look at Trends*—Analyze external trends and forces shaping the region.
- *Set a Vision*—Develop a broadly shared vision and goals for regional development.

¹ Collaborative Planning Theory (CPT) recognizes that urban areas and regions are composed of all kinds of interconnected, complex, adaptive systems. Complex adaptive systems are made up of separate self-regulating components that are constantly changing in response to their environment or conditions, and are difficult to understand or predict as a result. Given this environment, CPT charts a path for positively

transforming social conditions through ongoing dialogue with a diverse set of stakeholders and the public and using that dialogue to identify shared values and goals, while realizing that we can never fully reconcile the range of perspectives within our pluralistic society. The ultimate goal of planning, then, is to help shape decision-making guided by shared values and goals.

- *Choose Strategies*—Recommend strategies to achieve the vision and goals.
- *Select Transportation Projects*—Decide how limited funds will be invested in transportation infrastructure.
- *Make it Happen*—Work with partners to put the Plan into action and check if it's working.

This planning process informs a parallel effort around developing a long-range financial plan for transportation infrastructure investments over the next 25 years. This includes a Revenue Forecast, Needs Assessment, Funding Allocations, Project Evaluation, and Funding Analysis. For more details, see *Appendix F—Financial Plan*.

Public feedback is essential to shaping the vision for the Plan, ensuring it reflects the values and priorities of those who live and work in the region. Implementation strategies and funding decisions are developed by subject matter experts and planning partners, who collaborate to create a practical path toward realizing that vision.

Figure A-1: DVRPC Long-Range Planning Process



Source: DVRPC, 2025.

Stakeholder and Public Outreach

DVRPC recognizes effective public involvement as an ongoing and dynamic process, essential to addressing the future transportation, land use, and economic needs of Greater Philadelphia residents. Implementing regional plans and site-specific projects requires coordinated action among public, private, and nonprofit sectors, as well as engagement with the public. The Commission is committed to fostering a responsive public participation program that actively seeks input, ensures timely responses, and integrates public feedback at all levels of planning. Stakeholder and public outreach that informed the development of the *Update: Connections 2050 Plan* included focus groups with communities negatively impacted by transportation investments, a public-facing survey that tested

public support for the vision and goals in the previous *Connections 2050 Plan*, work with the Futures Group to update the *Dispatches from Alternate Futures* scenarios, engagement with standing regional committees, and a 30-day public comment period on the draft version of this Plan. Table A-1 summarizes the outreach efforts that guided the development of the *Update: Connections 2050 Plan*.

Public Participation Plan

DVRPC's *Public Participation Plan: A Strategy for Citizen Involvement*,² outlines how the Commission meets all federal public participation mandates. It is regularly updated to reflect the Commission's current outreach activities, particularly the Public Participation Task Force. The plan conveys DVRPC's commitment to a transparent and proactive public participation process that strives to engage all residents of Greater Philadelphia.

² Alison Hastings and Shoshana Akins, "DVRPC Public Participation Plan: A Strategy for Citizen Involvement," *The Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission*, January 2019, www.dvrpc.org/products/tm18012/.

Table A-1: *Update: Connections 2050* Stakeholder and Public Participation Activities

Public Participation Plan Goals	Implementation in the Long-Range Planning Process
Provide opportunities for interested parties to identify regional concerns and priorities.	• >20 meetings of the Regional Technical Committee's Financial Planning Subcommittee. • 1,336 survey responses on vision and goals from the general public. • Two scenario planning workshops with the Futures Working Group.
Encourage public involvement among our various audiences, including traditionally underserved groups.	• Targeted engagement of 153 organizations focused on community, youth, and business development. • Four focus group discussions explored how Long-range Plan projects impact underserved communities.
Increase the public's awareness of opportunities and activities to actively participate in DVRPC plans and programs.	• Social media and newsletters to >13,400 recipients. • Media toolkits for planning partners to advertise survey opportunities.
Obtain meaningful public input to inform the Commission's planning and decision-making process.	• Collected, analyzed, and used 500 public comments from the <i>Connections 2050</i> comment period, plus thousands of data points from 1,300+ participants of the visioning survey, to inform the regional vision and financial plan.

Public Participation Plan Goals	Implementation in the Long-Range Planning Process
	Public comments and staff/member agency responses were presented to the DVRPC Regional Technical Committee and Board.
Inform and educate our stakeholders, share information, and increase overall awareness of regional planning, land use, economic, environmental, fairness, and transportation issues and activities in the Greater Philadelphia region.	- Public-facing communications tools such as DVRPC’s website, newsletter, social media, and publications share accessible information and updates on planning activities and regional trends. - Outreach and engagement efforts—including public meetings, standing committees, surveys, and events—help inform and educate stakeholders while building broader awareness of planning and policy issues affecting the region.

Source: DVRPC, 2025.

General Public

DVRPC conducted various outreach activities to gather input from the public at key stages of the planning process.

Targeted Demographic Outreach

Planning must be done with the involvement and for the benefit of all the region’s residents. DVRPC is guided by federal Title VI and nondiscrimination mandates, and the Commission strives to not only meet these mandates but to create a transparent, collaborative planning process that serves everyone in the region. Community engagement is specifically promoted in Title

VI as a method to ensure the full and fair participation of potentially affected and underserved communities.

Staff hosted four focus groups in July and August of 2023 to discuss the impact of transportation projects on daily life for people who live in areas that have disproportionately experienced negative impacts from transportation investments. The methodology for organizing the focus groups was informed by federal guidance and additional best practices identified through research. In addition, the project team consulted with DVRPC’s Public Participation Task Force to prepare a script of questions to ask the focus groups. Engagement aimed to better

understand the perceptions of regionally funded transportation investments and to solicit feedback on a sample of projects already programmed in the current Board-adopted Long-Range Plan, *Connections 2050*.

DVRPC recruited for focus group meetings through multiple channels, including its website, newsletter, and social media. Emails with a partner toolkit were sent to over 40 community groups and 150 Registered Community Organizations (RCOs) in Philadelphia. Flyers were distributed to 60 public libraries, and paid ads targeted communities in Camden, NJ, and Upper Darby, PA, including a Spanish-language ad in *Impacto*. In-person sessions were held in transit-accessible locations to ensure low-income residents did not have financial difficulty attending. Beyond meeting federal outreach requirements, these focus groups were a key component of ensuring the Plan advances the regional vision.

Visioning Outreach

In the fall of 2023, DVRPC conducted a comprehensive outreach effort to engage residents, workers, and visitors across the Greater Philadelphia region in shaping the region's future. The goal of this outreach was to gather public input on the existing regional vision and to introduce a new element related to non-transportation infrastructure to the existing four: Transportation, Environment, Communities, and Economy.

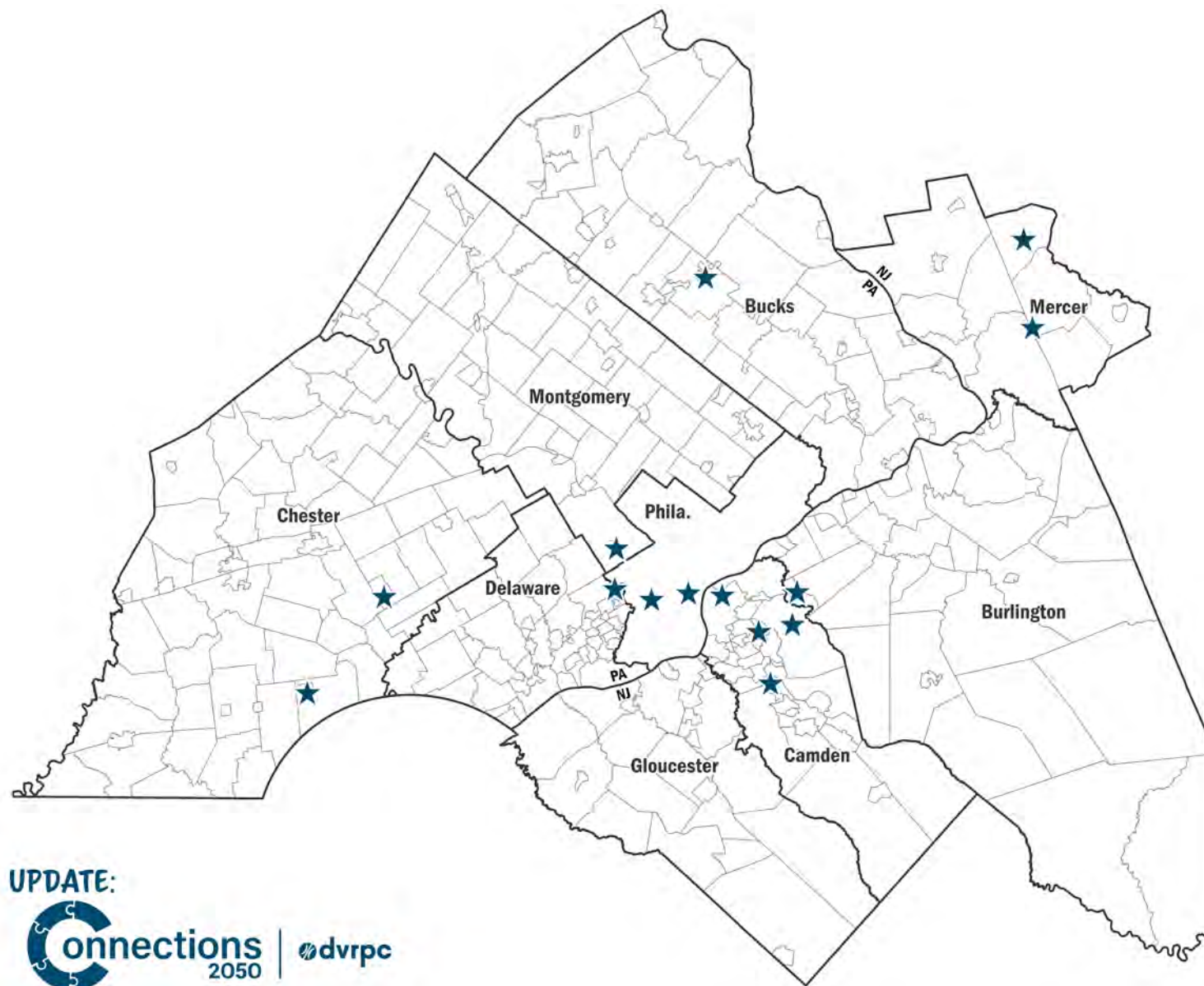
DVRPC developed a survey that could be taken in person or online and launched a web page to host online versions of the survey. Surveys were made available in both long and short formats, and in English, Spanish, and Chinese. Participants were invited to share their perspectives on what should be added, removed, or changed within the existing vision, as well as the goals under each plan element.

DVRPC employed a range of in-person and online engagement strategies to ensure broad participation.

DVRPC staff attended 15 community and professional events throughout the region to talk to individuals about the Plan and collect in-person surveys on their priorities for the region (see Figure A-2). The events took place in communities across the region:

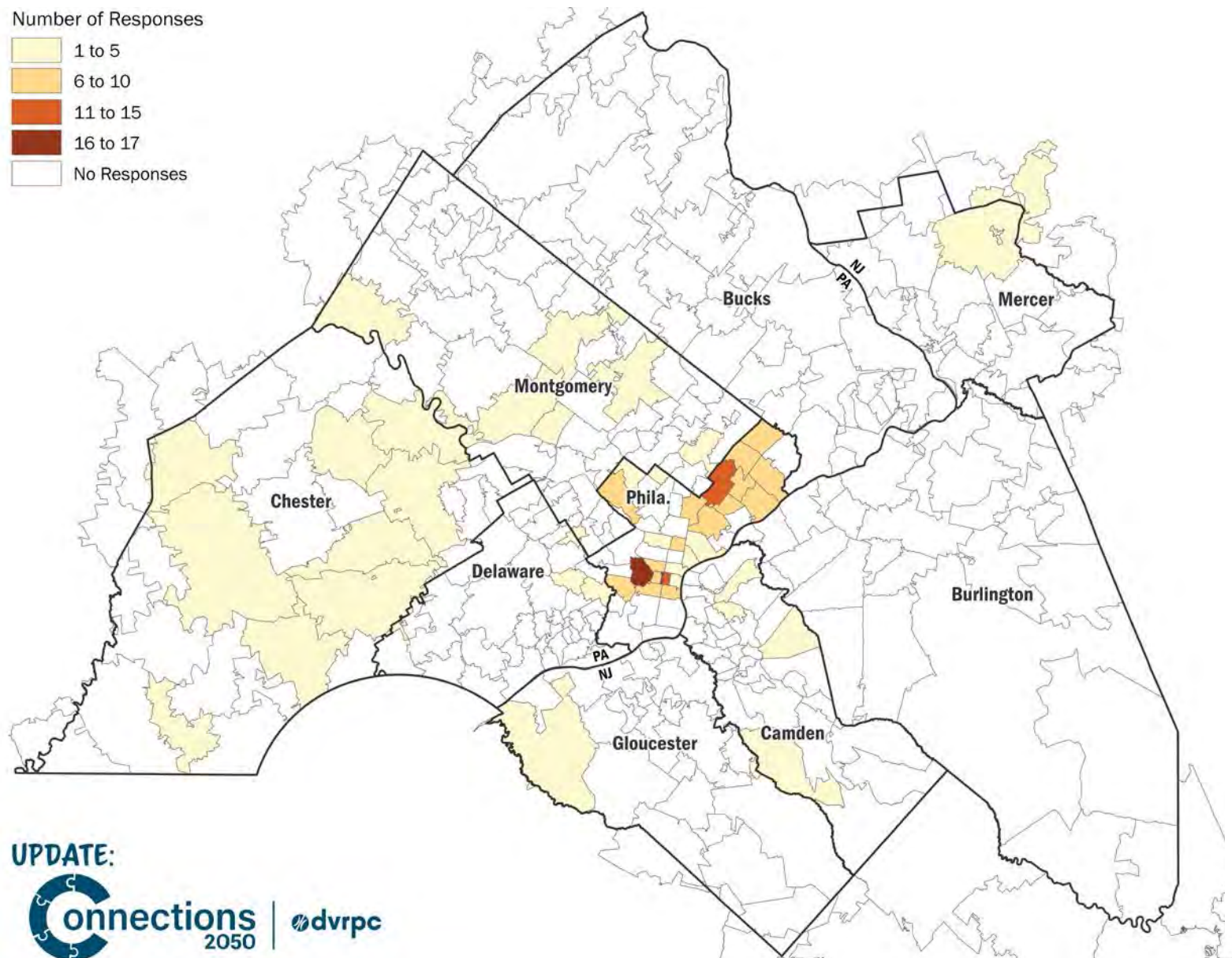
- Camden, NJ
- Cherry Hill, NJ
- Haddon Township, NJ
- Magnolia, NJ
- Maple Shade, NJ
- Princeton, NJ
- Princeton Junction, NJ
- Doylestown, PA
- Kennett Square, PA
- Narberth, PA
- Philadelphia, PA
- Upper Darby, PA
- West Chester, PA

Figure A-2: Vision Outreach Event Locations



Source: DVRPC, 2025.

Figure A-3: Geographic Distribution of Survey Respondents by ZIP Code



The survey was promoted online through paid social media ads and organic social media posts. The survey was also advertised through DVRPC's monthly newsletter and an email series targeting different audiences.

Staff created a partner toolkit to promote the survey and shared it with Philadelphia's RCOs, environmental groups throughout the region, community organizations, university contacts, communications staff for the nine counties in the DVRPC region, and the region's Transportation Management Associations (TMAs). Flyers advertising the survey were also distributed to libraries throughout the region.

DVRPC received over 1,300 validated survey responses during this visioning process. Responses came from every county within the region. Figure A-3 shows ZIP codes by range of responses submitted.

Visioning Feedback

Participants across the region share a strong and unified vision for a fairer, environmentally friendly, and connected future. Feedback emphasizes the importance of affordability, access to opportunity, environmental stewardship, and decision-making involving all affected members of the public. While priorities vary by focus area, respondents consistently express support for coordinated action that addresses long-standing disparities and improves quality of life for all residents. The following feedback is organized by Plan element.

Transportation

Survey respondents consistently prioritize improvements to public transportation, walking, and biking infrastructure. There is strong support for expanding safe, reliable, and frequent transit service, especially to better serve seniors, people with disabilities, and lower-income communities. Participants emphasized the need for better sidewalk and bike connections, traffic calming measures, and reduced dependence on cars. Safety is a major theme, with many calling for protected bike lanes and safer pedestrian crossings. While some feedback focused on reducing congestion, the broader theme is a desire to shift toward a more multimodal and accessible transportation system.

Economy

Public input on the economy highlights the importance of supporting small, local businesses. Respondents expressed a strong interest in revitalizing commercial corridors through mixed-use development and walkable design. There was significant support for workforce development programs, particularly related to technology and skilled trades. Economic opportunity was closely tied to land use, with community members noting the importance of proximity to jobs, services, and transit. Many comments link economic resilience to broader environmental goals, housing access, and economic mobility for all.

Community

Community-focused feedback centers on housing affordability, land use, and neighborhood development that does not displace residents. Participants emphasize the urgent need for more affordable housing options and a greater variety of housing types. Many support zoning reforms to allow for more multifamily housing and accessory dwelling units, particularly near transit. While compact, walkable development is widely supported, some respondents raise concerns about maintaining neighborhood character and preventing displacement. Respondents also called for investments in public spaces, schools, and services that contribute to a high quality of life. A strong desire for planning processes and outcomes that reflect and serve all communities emerged across all responses.

Environment

Respondents strongly support policies and investments that protect natural resources, enhance green space, and promote environmental resilience. Feedback emphasizes the importance of preserving tree canopy, improving air and water quality, and using green infrastructure to manage stormwater and heat. Many participants express concern about pollution and environmental degradation, particularly in communities located near industrial areas. There is wide support for environmentally responsible development, such as high-performance buildings and environmentally conscious and risk-informed land use planning. The public voiced a clear expectation that environmental goals be integrated across transportation, housing, and economic strategies.

Infrastructure & Utility Services

The public has a strong interest in reducing air pollution through electrification and expresses deep concern about changing weather patterns. Respondents support strategies such as rooftop solar, building electrification, community resilience hubs, electric vehicle infrastructure, and transit investment. There is also strong support for preparing for extreme weather, especially heat and flooding, by investing in measures that reduce risk from these events, particularly for vulnerable populations. Many respondents call for more widespread access to utility programs and investments, ensuring that the benefits of emerging technologies and market transformation related to infrastructure and utilities are shared across all communities.

Plan History & Disparities

Past planning practices in the United States have contributed to deep social and economic divides through exclusionary zoning, redlining, urban renewal, and highway construction that displaced entire neighborhoods, particularly Black and Brown communities. In Greater Philadelphia, as in much of the country, early planning efforts often excluded meaningful input from those most affected, reinforcing segregation, car dependency, and the loss of neighborhood cohesion.

While the consequences of these policies continue to affect communities today, the planning field has gradually evolved to focus on broader prosperity, quality of life, and more representative public engagement. DVRPC's recent efforts

reflect this shift, with an emphasis on increasing access to transportation, housing, and economic opportunities for residents who have historically been left out of planning decisions.

Initiatives such as the Chinatown Stitch,³ Reimagining Regional Rail,⁴ and Bus Revolution⁵ demonstrate how DVRPC and its partners are working to improve outreach, expand travel choices, and reconsider past infrastructure decisions through a more community-responsive lens. Planners today are striving to rebuild trust and address long-standing disparities by centering community voices in decision-making, improving connections to jobs and services, and targeting investment where it is most needed.

Although certain structural challenges remain, DVRPC is committed to advancing planning practices that support a more connected and thriving region for all who live and work here.

Standing Committees

DVRPC works closely with a diverse range of stakeholders to ensure transportation planning reflects the needs and priorities of the region. In addition to the DVRPC Board, DVRPC convenes and facilitates several committees to guide decision-making and project development. Committees are made up of representatives from government agencies, the private sector,

academia, community organizations, and the public. DVRPC convenes 11 stakeholder committees:⁶

- Public Participation Task Force (PPTF)
- Regional Technical Committee (RTC)
- Delaware Valley Goods Movement Task Force (DVGMTF)
- Central Jersey Transportation Forum (CJTF)
- Regional Safety Task Force (RSTF)
- Information Resources Exchange Group (IREG)
- Greater Philadelphia Futures Group
- Healthy Communities Task Force (HCTF)
- Comprehensive Economic Development Strategy Committee (CEDS)
- Transportation Operations Task Force (TOTF)
- Regional Travel Demand Management Advisory Committee (TDM)

DVRPC collaborated with committee members in developing the Plan. The engagement with the PPTF, FWG, and DVGMTF is detailed in the following section.

Public Participation Task Force (PPTF)

The Public Participation Task Force (PPTF) has been actively involved throughout the development of the Plan. As DVRPC's primary vehicle for ongoing public involvement, the PPTF is

³ City of Philadelphia. "The Chinatown Stitch: Reconnecting Philadelphia to Vine Street." Complete Streets Program. www.phila.gov/programs/complete-streets/projects/the-chinatown-stitch-reconnecting-philadelphia-to-vine-street/.

⁴ Southeastern Pennsylvania Transportation Authority (SEPTA). "Reimagining Regional Rail." SEPTA Initiatives. www.septa.org/initiatives/regional-rail/reimagining-regional-rail/

⁵ Southeastern Pennsylvania Transportation Authority (SEPTA). "Bus Revolution." SEPTA News. www.septa.org/news/tag/bus-revolution/

⁶ www.dvrpc.org/committees/

composed of representatives from the private sector, social service agencies, environmental organizations, and other interested stakeholders. The committee provided valuable feedback on the content, structure, and communication of the draft Plan.

DVRPC hosts at least one dedicated annual PPTF meeting to present an overview of the Plan's progress and major components. Staff share public-facing presentation materials for input and facilitate trial workshops with PPTF members to refine outreach strategies and engagement tools before they are implemented with broader audiences. In addition to this advisory role, PPTF members also serve as public representatives on the Financial Planning Subcommittee of the Regional Technical Committee (RTC), helping to ensure that public perspectives are incorporated into key funding decisions and long-range investment priorities.

Futures Group

The Futures Group is a collaborative, transdisciplinary group of subject matter experts and interested stakeholders that meet on a quarterly basis to discuss emerging trends and forces (social, technological, environmental, economic, or political), and how they are shaping the Greater Philadelphia region. Every four years, a subset of the larger Futures Group—The Futures Working Group (FWG)—conducts an exploratory scenario planning exercise as part of developing the Long-Range Plan.

As part of the Plan update, DVRPC convened a new FWG to review the scenarios (Figure A-4) developed as part of the *Connections 2050* plan, reported in *Dispatches from Alternate Futures: Exploratory Scenarios for Greater Philadelphia*⁷ and update these scenarios with recent trends and events that could significantly impact the region's future. The FWG identified new opportunities, challenges, and strategies. For example, they highlighted the ability to leverage better data for improved efficiency and transparency among communities, governments, and stakeholders. They also shared concerns around fair access to data, housing, and economic opportunities.

The FWG proposed several strategies to leverage emerging opportunities and address challenges. These strategies include fostering microdemocracy through community-led initiatives; implementing standardized design guides for municipalities to implement high-performing, clean buildings, infrastructure, and walkable communities; and enhancing tech literacy for all stakeholders. The FWG also recommended that at least five percent of total regional funding be directed toward resiliency, bike and pedestrian infrastructure, and microtransit projects.

⁷ Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission, *Dispatches from Alternate Futures: Exploratory Scenarios for Greater Philadelphia*, DVRPC Publication No. 20012 (Philadelphia: DVRPC, July 2020), www.dvrpc.org/products/20012.

Figure A-4: Dispatches from Alternate Futures Scenarios



Source: DVRPC, 2019.

Delaware Valley Goods Movement Task Force

In a scenario planning exercise to explore trends shaping both global and regional supply chains and to project how these might evolve by 2024, DVRPC's Freight Program engaged the Delaware Valley Goods Movement Task Force (DVGMTF)—its

freight advisory committee, which includes representatives from the trucking, rail, port, airport, shipper, and freight forwarding industries, as well as economic development partners and member governments. Through surveys, an in-person workshop, and virtual breakout sessions, DVRPC gathered input on trends, opportunities, and challenges that impact the freight community. This input helped bring an understanding of the broader system of factors influencing infrastructure and the regional supply chain. One major insight from the group was that external disruptions and technological innovations are the primary forces shaping goods movement—and that regional coordination is essential to maintaining a stable supply chain.

The findings informed the publication *Freight Futures*,⁸ which outlines strategies across multiple areas of the supply chain, including workforce development, rail service promotion, truck parking, adaptive reuse of industrial spaces, and emerging technology to create a more balanced and resilient regional freight network. These strategies also shaped the strategy recommendations in the Plan.

Public Comment Period

In addition to public engagement throughout the planning process, federal regulations require that MPOs provide an opportunity for public input before adopting a long-range plan. A minimum 30-day public comment period must be conducted prior to formal adoption of long-range plans. This requirement

⁸ Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission, *Freight Futures*, DVRPC Publication No.23142 (Philadelphia: DVRPC, September 2024), www.dvrpc.org/products/23142.

helps ensure that plans reflect regional values, priorities, and needs by incorporating feedback from a broad range of stakeholders and the public. DVRPC meets this requirement through a transparent process that includes public notices, distribution of draft materials, public meetings, and documented responses to all substantive comments received.

Incorporating Feedback from the Previous Plan

During the 30-day public comment period for the *Connections 2050 Plan* in 2021, DVRPC received nearly 500 comments from the public.⁹ This feedback provided valuable insight into regional priorities and highlighted areas where the Plan could better reflect community values. Several key themes emerged from these comments:

- A desire for more explicit and sustained support for bicycle and pedestrian infrastructure, especially the Circuit Trail Network.
- Widespread opposition to new roadway widening projects.
- Concerns that certain planned projects—such as I-95 and the US 30 Bypass—might conflict with the Plan’s stated environmental goals.
- A strong call to reprioritize funding in favor of transit, bicycle, and pedestrian investments.

- Requests to pursue specific projects, such as Roosevelt Boulevard Transit, the High-Quality Bike Network, Trolley Modernization, the Spring Garden Greenway, the Chinatown Stitch (cap over I-676), I-76 Active Traffic Management, and expansions to SEPTA Regional Rail and the Broad Street Line.
- Calls for increased land preservation efforts to get the region on track to meet its long-standing goal of preserving one million acres of open space.

In response to this public feedback, DVRPC made several targeted changes to the *Connections 2050 Plan* in 2021:

- Adding new strategies to advance the region’s Vision Zero goal.
- Changing the funding category for Circuit Trail projects to “Illustrative” to clarify they are eligible for funding as they are ready to advance into design or construction.
- Providing more detailed information about available federal funding programs and their constraints, to help clarify what can and cannot be accomplished through the Plan.
- Strengthening the Plan’s call for increased investment in land preservation at the local, state, and federal levels.

Following the adoption of *Connections 2050*, DVRPC undertook additional efforts to address the broader questions raised about

⁹ Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission, *Connections 2050 Long-Range Plan: Public Comments*, accessed October 29, 2025, www.dvrpc.org/PlanComments/.

roadway expansion. These included a Seminar on Induced Demand, a Congestion Management Process Peer Exchange hosted by FHWA's Transportation Planning Capacity Building program, and a DVRPC Board policy meeting. These dialogues helped the region build consensus around a more measured approach to roadway expansion, supporting only limited, critical investments as a last resort to address congestion, bottlenecks, and population growth.

Many of the projects specifically requested during the *Connections 2050* comment period are now being advanced through this updated Plan:

- Trolley Modernization
- Connecting our Chinatown (formerly the Chinatown Stitch cap over I-676)
- The Spring Garden Connector (formerly Spring Garden Greenway)
- I-76 Active Traffic Management
- Partial funding for the High-Quality Bike Network
- Continued study and near-term safety improvements for Roosevelt Boulevard

The Plan also reaffirms support for major aspirational investments that remain dependent on future funding, such as SEPTA's Reimagining Regional Rail, Bus Revolution, the Glassboro-Camden Line, the Broad Street Line extension to the Navy Yard, and the Media-Wawa Line extension to West Chester.

Public Comment Period for *Update: Connections 2050*

The draft versions of the *Update: Connections 2050 Summary* document and its appendices were available for public comment from July 18, 2025, through August 20, 2025. These materials were accessible via a temporary website at www.dvrpc.org/plan/draft/, and at various regional libraries. The public comment period was announced through legal notices in local newspapers, postings on the DVRPC website, and email notifications to more than 12,000 recipients on DVRPC's distribution list, as well as to tribal governments in the region.

As part of the comment period, DVRPC hosted two public information sessions:

- In-person on August 5, 2025, from 6:00 PM to 7:30 PM at the Mullica Hill Library in Gloucester County, New Jersey.
- Hybrid in-person/online on August 7, 2025, from 6:00 PM to 7:30 PM at DVRPC's Philadelphia office.

Comments were required to be submitted in writing by:

Email: to LRP@dvrpc.org, or

Mail: Public Comments
c/o DVRPC Office of Communications and Engagement
190 N. Independence Mall West, 8th Fl.,
Philadelphia, PA 19106-1520

DVRPC hosts a database for public comments and responses from DVRPC and its planning partners at www.dvrpc.org/PlanComments. These are available for long-

range plans and amendments to plans from 2021 to the present day. Comments on plans and amendments published before 2021 can be found in DVRPC's products database at www.dvrpc.org/products/. DVRPC considered changes to the Draft Plan based on comments received. Even if DVRPC could not incorporate a comment in the Plan prior to adoption, the comment may still be used to inform the development of the next Plan.

A total of 165 public comments were received, all via email:

- 68 comments from 5th Square's campaign urged shifting funds from highways to transit, safety, and active transportation. Recommendations included revising Roosevelt Boulevard for high-capacity transit, expanding the I-95 scope to study removal/tunneling, and eliminating future highway extensions and widenings, citing Colorado's policy as a model. Commenters also supported doubling funding for Philadelphia's High-Quality Bike Network, adding Vision Zero intersection improvements, and investing in new transit projects such as Regional Rail infill stations, Northwest Philadelphia transit, and corridor extensions.
- 58 comments originated from a campaign by the Bicycle Coalition of Greater Philadelphia. They expressed appreciation for full funding of the Circuit network and emphasized support for completing the Circuit Trails by 2040. They also endorsed key investments, including State Road Reconstruction, the Philly High-Quality Bike

Network, the Spring Garden Connector, PA 291/Second Street/Industrial Highway Complete Streets, and Vision Zero safety improvements. In addition, the comments recommended establishing a benchmark and tracking system to monitor Circuit funding through individual projects.

- 15 similar messages on U.S. 1, RC3 Improvements,¹⁰ related to project ID# PAR004 (see Table F-24). Residents and local officials voiced opposition to the proposed cloverleaf and frontage road closures, citing concerns about traffic diversion, safety risks, impacts on Langhorne's historic character, environmental effects, and economic costs. Many questioned the validity of the studies and expressed support for alternative work as a cheaper, safer, and faster option.
- 23 additional comments were unique submissions. Common themes included strong support for transit funding and expansion, opposition to roadway widening, and calls for more investment in bicycle and pedestrian improvements. In addition, respondents raised specific requests related to individual projects.

Of the existing projects in the Draft Plan that were referenced in comments, 13 were mentioned with support, and 12 were mentioned with opposition. Additionally, two new roadway projects and four new transit projects were proposed.

For the first time in a plan update, DVRPC used a large language model in a focused, limited way to help organize and draft initial

¹⁰ Pennsylvania Department of Transportation, "Section RC3," *U.S. 1 Improvements Project: Bucks County*, accessed August 25, 2025, <https://us1bucks.com/section-rc3/>.

responses to public comments—drawing only from our own Draft Plan and relevant federal policies. This innovation helped us process feedback more efficiently, while ensuring every comment was still reviewed and finalized by DVRPC staff and partners. As a leader in innovative regional planning, we are committed to using technology responsibly, with minimal computing needs, to strengthen the voices of the people who live and work in the region. A full acknowledgement statement is posted at the online database with comments at www.dvrpc.org/PlanComments/.

Also, for the first time in a plan update, DVRPC convened the Financial Planning Subcommittee of the RTC to review comments received, in addition to its usual practice of coordinating with planning partners to respond to comments on an individual basis. The discussion centered on those comments with regional implications, suggestions for potential changes, and issues requiring nuanced responses. Following the meeting, DVRPC reached out to all project sponsors and affected counties for input, then incorporated partner feedback into a single, consolidated response. The final responses explicitly highlight where collaboration with partners took place.

Incorporating Feedback from the Public Comment Period

Changes from the draft Plan for public comment include updates to both the Summary Document and Appendices. The Summary Document now features letters from the DVRPC Executive Director and Chair of the Board, along with revised

graphics on population, employment, and funding allocation. In the Appendices, the Roosevelt Boulevard Line description has been updated from “Surface Transit” to “High-Capacity Transit,” and the US 202/PA 611 (Doylestown Bypass) Preventative Maintenance project has been shifted to Period 3 of the Plan with an updated cost. Additional updates include the addition of BFP and NEVI-FP formula funding programs in Table E-2, as well as revisions to this section (Public Comment) that analyze comments and acknowledge AI support. Finally, new project recommendations will be reviewed by partners before the next call for projects.

Plan Administration

Update: Connections 2050 was developed under the Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act (IIJA) federal transportation legislation, which sets planning requirements that must be considered in the Plan’s formation. These include consideration for a set of federal planning factors, transportation performance management (TPM) metrics and targets, and air quality conformity analysis.

Federal Planning Requirements

DVRPC is required by the U.S. Department of Transportation (USDOT), per federal planning regulations, to develop a plan for a minimum 20-year horizon.^{11, 12} Since the region is a nonattainment and maintenance area for air quality standards for ground-level ozone and fine particulate matter, federal

¹¹ Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act, Pub. L. No. 117-58, § 11201, 135 Stat. 429 (2021).

¹² 23 U.S.C. §§ 134-135 (2021).

planning regulations require that the long-range plan be updated every four years to reflect and respond to the most recent trends and needs of the region.^{13, 14} *Update: Connections 2050* is also in alignment with the 2023 FHWA publication, *Model Long-Range Transportation Plans: A Guide for Performance-Based Planning*.¹⁵

Planning Factors

Under Federal Highway Administration (FHWA) and Federal Transit Administration (FTA) Joint Planning Regulations, MPOs like DVRPC must incorporate performance-based planning and

programming (PBPP) and address national goals, including safety, infrastructure condition, congestion reduction, and system reliability.

Long-range plans must be developed through a comprehensive, cooperative, and continuing process that ensures coordination and compatibility across agencies and jurisdictions. Federal regulations also mandate that the Plan address 10 planning factors, guiding the selection and implementation of projects, strategies, and services.¹⁶ Table A-2 outlines these planning factors and summarizes how DVRPC has integrated them into *Update: Connections 2050*.

¹³ Infrastructure Investment and Jobs Act, Pub. L. No. 117-58, § 11201, 135 Stat. 429 (2021).

¹⁴ 23 U.S.C. §§ 134-135 (2021).

¹⁵ Federal Highway Administration, *Performance-Based Planning and Programming Guidebook*, FHWA-HEP-13-041 (Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Transportation, September 2013), accessed June 11, 2024, www.fhwa.dot.gov/planning/performance_based_planning/mlrtp_guidebook/index.cfm.

¹⁶ U.S. Department of Transportation, Federal Highway Administration, "23 C.F.R. § 450.300–.340: Metropolitan Transportation Planning and Programming", in Electronic Code of Federal Regulations, revised as of June 25, 2025, subpart C of title 23, chapter I, subchapter E, part 450, accessed June 25, 2025, www.ecfr.gov/current/title-23/chapter-I/subchapter-E/part-450/subpart-C.

Table A-2: DVRPC Consideration of FHWA Planning Factors

FHWA Planning Factor	Update: Connections 2050 Consideration
(1) Support the economic vitality of the metropolitan area, especially by enabling global competitiveness, productivity, and efficiency.	The Plan's vision has a focus area on growing an innovative and connected economy with opportunity and shared prosperity. Goals include a well-trained and adaptable regional workforce; a variety of regional economic sectors; and reliable physical and digital access to regional, national, and global resources and markets. Each has strategies for implementation.
(2) Increase the safety of the transportation system for motorized and nonmotorized users.	The Plan maintains a strategy to take a Safe Systems approach to achieving the DVRPC regional Vision Zero goal and enhance security for all users. It identifies a range of actions to safely accommodate walking, rolling, transit, and transportation network users. Safety is the most heavily weighted criterion in the <i>Plan-TIP Project Evaluation Criteria</i> (adopted October 2023), scoring higher for projects if they implement FHWA proven safety countermeasures or other safety strategies with specific crash reduction factors, addressing state Department of Transportation (DOT)-identified high-crash locations, or implement safety strategies at locations with documented safety concerns in a Public Transportation Agency Safety Plan (PTASP).
(3) Increase the security of the transportation system for motorized and nonmotorized users.	The Plan sets a goal for a transportation network that is, and feels, safe and secure for all and identifies strategies to strengthen transportation security through coordination among agencies, updated cybersecurity measures, and environmental design.
(4) Increase the accessibility and mobility of people and freight.	The Plan has several strategies that address this factor, including preserving and maintaining infrastructure critical to freight and regional mobility, expanding and improving transit access, expanding active and multimodal transportation options, managing travel Demand, and ensuring safe transportation operations. The Plan's Economy element and goal for reliable physical and digital access to regional, national, and global resources and markets expands on this by incorporating the goods movement, digital connections, land use, and international trade.
(5) Protect and enhance the environment, promote conservation, improve the quality of life, and promote consistency between transportation improvements and	The Plan's vision includes a preserved and restored natural environment and healthy ecological systems, and reliable and affordable infrastructure and utility services built with the resilience to mitigate and withstand the effects of extreme weather.

FHWA Planning Factor	Update: Connections 2050 Consideration
State and local planned growth and economic development patterns.	The Plan includes goals and strategies for achieving these vision elements. The Plan's land use vision ensures consistency with growth and development patterns.
(6) Enhance the integration and connectivity of the transportation system across and between modes throughout the state, for people and freight.	The Plan establishes a goal for connected and integrated transportation modes in a state of good repair (SGR). It recommends a range of strategies to improve system interconnectivity, through both digital solutions such as unified fare payment systems and coordinated scheduling, and physical ones, including multimodal connections of existing and emerging transportation modes and first- and last-mile solutions.
(7) Promote efficient system management and operation.	The Plan focuses on efficient mobility and encourages growth in mixed-use, walkable Plan Centers that make efficient use of infrastructure; provide access to essential services; and consume fewer resources. The transportation element also includes strategies for efficient operations, such as Traffic Incident Management (TIM), emergency response coordination, and interoperable technologies.
(8) Emphasize the preservation of the existing transportation system.	The Plan prioritizes preservation and SGR investments aligned with DOT and transit agency asset management plans. Projects were prioritized if they were rehabilitation or replacement, consistent with a lowest life-cycle cost approach. The Plan recognizes that resiliency measures may be necessary for infrastructure to withstand the effects of extreme weather.
(9) Improve the resiliency and reliability of the transportation system and reduce or mitigate stormwater impacts of surface transportation.	The Plan includes a strategy to build and maintain resilient infrastructure. This strategy requires using future weather projections when designing housing, commercial buildings, and critical infrastructure such as water, transportation, and power systems. The Plan addresses extreme weather risks by integrating nature-based solutions, enhancing disaster recovery capabilities, and improving drainage and stormwater management in transportation projects.
(10) Enhance travel and tourism.	The Plan's goal for reliable physical and digital access to regional, national, and global resources and markets includes access for visitors of the region. The Plan includes strategies to enhance access to parks, open space, and recreational areas, ensuring natural and cultural amenities are preserved and enhanced for residents and visitors alike.

Source: DVRPC, 2025.

Federal transportation legislation mandates that states and MPOs incorporate performance measures; set targets; and monitor progress of their long-range plans in the areas of safety, infrastructure preservation, congestion reduction, system reliability, freight movement and economic vitality, environmental preservation, and reduced project delivery delays. These performance measures are detailed in Appendix C. DVRPC will continue to work with federal, state, and local planning partners on implementing the performance measures planning targets within the framework of the Plan.

Air Quality Conformity Demonstration

Transportation conformity is the federally required process by which MPOs demonstrate that the transportation investments and strategies in the Plan align with air quality goals in State Implementation Plans (SIPs) for meeting National Ambient Air Quality Standards (NAAQS). This ensures that air pollution from transportation projects does not exceed the limits set in SIP budgets for particulate matter, ozone, carbon monoxide, sulfur dioxide, nitrogen dioxide, and lead.

Under the Federal Clean Air Act and transportation planning provisions, areas that do not meet or have previously not met NAAQS are designated as nonattainment or maintenance areas. These areas require a conformity analysis to ensure that transportation projects included in the Plan support progress toward meeting federal air quality standards. The nine-county DVRPC region is part of four nonattainment or maintenance areas:

- Philadelphia-Wilmington-Atlantic City Ozone Nonattainment Area
- Philadelphia-Wilmington, PA-NJ-DE PM_{2.5} Maintenance Area
- New York - Northern New Jersey - Long Island, NY-NJ-CT PM_{2.5} Maintenance Area
- Delaware County PM_{2.5} Maintenance Area

Major Regional Projects funded in the fiscally constrained ("Funded") Plan that are deemed air quality significant must undergo an air quality conformity analysis. An air quality significant project has the potential to impact regional air quality by affecting transportation-related pollutants. These projects typically fall into categories that influence vehicle travel, such as:

1. Capacity-expanding roadway projects, such as adding new highway lanes (including part-time shoulder use), new interchanges or additional movements to existing interchanges, or major road widenings
2. Major transit projects, such as new rail lines, major transit expansions, or changes that significantly alter ridership patterns
3. Projects that affect travel demand, such as high-occupancy vehicle lanes, major park-and-ride facilities, roundabouts, extending through lanes through intersections, large-scale signal timing changes, or removing travel lanes

Regional conformity analysis evaluates projects funded in the TIP and Plan as a group to ensure they align with federal air

quality standards set by the Clean Air Act. Specifically, funded projects must be included in the Transportation Conformity Determination, which assesses whether planned transportation investments will help a region meet its air quality goals for the six NAAQS air pollutants. This analysis is required at least once every four years, or (1) when a new Plan or Transportation Improvement Program (TIP) is adopted, or (2) an air quality significant project is added, amended, or deleted.

DVRPC demonstrates conformity by using a travel demand model to estimate the motor vehicle air pollutants from non-exempt projects in the TIPs and long-range plans, then comparing those pollutants against budgets or limits established by the states. This process is conducted in collaboration with an interagency consultation group, including state and federal regulatory, environmental, and transportation agencies. A 30-day public comment period and two meetings on air quality conformity findings were scheduled concurrently with the draft DVRPC FFY 2026 TIP for NJ and the draft *Update: Connections 2050* Plan.

DVRPC successfully demonstrated conformity for the Update: Connections 2050 Plan, in Transportation Conformity Determination: Update: Connections 2050 Long-Range Plan FFY TIP2026 for New Jersey FFY 2025 TIP for Pennsylvania (Publication #26106). This report shows that the region meets state implementation plans and Clean Air Act requirements. The transportation conformity analysis meets all applicable conformity criteria, including, but not limited to the following:

- The Plan is fiscally constrained [40 CFR 93.108].

- This determination is based on the latest planning assumptions [40 CFR 93.110].
- This determination is based on the latest air pollutants estimation model available [40 CFR 93.111].
- DVRPC has made the determination according to the applicable consultation procedures [40 CFR 93.112].
- The Plan does not interfere with the timely implementation of transportation control measures (TCMs) [40 CFR 93.113].
- The Plan is consistent with the budgets for pollutants from on-road vehicles (MVEBs) in the applicable State Implementation Plan [40 CFR 93.118].

More details are available at www.dvrpc.org/AirQuality/Conformity/.

Plan Consistency

The Long-Range Plan is developed through a collaborative and iterative process that ensures alignment with the goals of regional planning partners. Regular meetings of the RTC Financial Planning Subcommittee and presentations to the RTC and Board provided a platform for ongoing engagement, data-driven analysis, and consensus-building. The Plan integrates input from municipalities, counties, state agencies, transit providers, and other stakeholders. This approach strengthens coordination across jurisdictions and sectors, ensuring that planning efforts remain consistent with shared regional priorities while allowing flexibility to adapt to emerging needs.

Partner Plans

DVRPC strives to ensure that its long-range planning process and Plan are consistent with, and complementary to, the goals and policies outlined in the plans and programs of member

municipal and county governments, as well as the statewide transportation plans of the Pennsylvania and New Jersey departments of transportation (DOTs). Table A-3 includes a list of plans and policy documents that are consistent with *Update: Connections 2050*.

Table A-3: Partner Plans and Policy Documents for Consistency

Organization	Plan Type	Plan Title	Year Adopted
Bucks County	Comprehensive Plan	<u>Bucks2040, Building Our Future Together</u>	2024
Chester County	Comprehensive Plan	<u>Landscapes3</u>	2018
Delaware County	Comprehensive Plan	<u>Delaware County 2035</u>	2017
Montgomery County	Comprehensive Plan	<u>Montco 2040: A Shared Vision</u>	2015; 2021
City of Philadelphia	Comprehensive Plan	<u>Phila 2035</u>	2013
Burlington County	Highway Master Plan	<u>Burlington County Highway Master Plan</u>	2019
Camden County	Comprehensive Plan	<u>Camden County Master Plan</u>	2014
Gloucester County	Master Plan	<u>gc2040</u>	2015
Mercer County	Master Plan	<u>Mercer County Master Plan</u>	2010
Pennsylvania Department of Transportation (PennDOT)	Long-Range Transportation Plan	<u>Pennsylvania 2045 Long-Range Transportation Plan</u>	2022
PennDOT	Transportation Asset Management Plan (TAMP)	<u>PA State Transportation Asset Management Plan 2022</u>	2022

Organization	Plan Type	Plan Title	Year Adopted
PennDOT	State Transportation Improvement Program (STIP)	<u>PA State Transportation Improvement Program</u>	2024
New Jersey Department of Transportation (NJDOT)	Long-Range Transportation Plan	<u>KEEP IT MOVING NJ!</u>	2024
NJDOT	TAMP	<u>New Jersey Transportation Asset Management Plan</u>	2022
NJDOT	State Transportation Improvement Program (STIP)	<u>NJ Statewide Transportation Capital Program FFY 2026</u>	2025
DRPA-PATCO	Capital Program	<u>FY 2024–2033 PATCO Projects</u>	2023
New Jersey Office of Planning Advocacy	New Jersey State Plan	<u>New Jersey State Development and Redevelopment Plan</u>	2025
Southeastern Pennsylvania Transit Authority (SEPTA)	Strategic Plan	<u>SEPTA Forward</u>	2021
SEPTA	Capital Program	<u>FY2026 Capital Budget and FY 2026–2034 Capital Program</u>	2025
NJ Transit	Strategic Plan	<u>NJT2030</u>	2020
NJ Transit	Capital Program	<u>NJ Transit Five-Year Capital Plan</u>	2024

Source: DVRPC, 2025.

Other Regional Plans and Programs

The Long-Range Plan both informs and builds off several other key regional efforts. These include the Transportation

Improvement Program (TIP), the Congestion Management Process (CMP), the Comprehensive Economic Development Strategy (CEDS), and the Regional Vision Zero (RVZ) program.

Transportation Improvement Program (TIP)

DVRPC's TIPs are short-term implementation programs of capital improvements that are drawn from, and consistent with, the DVRPC Long-Range Plan. The TIP is multimodal in nature and includes bridge, roadway, bicycle, pedestrian, freight, operational, and public transit station, vehicle, equipment, and SGR projects of all sizes and scopes. Required by federal law to cover four years, the TIP represents the transportation improvement priorities of the region and lists all projects that intend to use federal funds, along with state-funded capital projects and toll authority air quality significant projects. Anticipated costs and schedules by phase are indicated for every project in the TIP. Project phases may include preliminary engineering, final design, right-of-way (ROW) acquisition, utility clearance, and construction for roadway-funded projects, and purchase, capital, operating, or debt service phases for public transit projects. The list of projects in the TIP must be financially constrained by the amount of funds that are reasonably expected to be available. More information about the TIPs for both Pennsylvania and New Jersey can be found at www.dvrpc.org/tip.

The Plan-TIP Project Evaluation Criteria, adopted in October 2023, is a key tool in aligning the TIP and the Long-Range Plan into a single financial plan. See more in *Appendix F—Financial Plan*.

Congestion Management Process (CMP)

The CMP is a requirement of the federal Surface Transportation Act legislation (23 CFR Parts 450.322 and 500.109) for urbanized areas (UZAs) with populations greater than 200,000, known as Transportation Management Areas (TMAs). These federal regulations specify that the CMP be implemented as a continuous part of the metropolitan planning process. Regulations require that alternatives to new single-occupant vehicle (SOV) road capacity be explored first, and where additional capacity is found to be necessary, multimodal supplemental strategies must be developed to obtain the most long-term value from the investment. The CMP must be regularly updated.

DVRPC's CMP ¹⁷ works to improve the reliable flow of people and goods, enhance safety, minimize costs, and promote consistency with the Plan. The CMP analysis starts by identifying the most congested roadways in Greater Philadelphia and then synthesizes this information with other analyses to recommend the most appropriate travel demand, operational management, and multimodal strategies that are context-sensitive to each congested facility. The CMP also evaluates the effectiveness of implemented strategies and uses the results to inform strategy recommendations.

The CMP provides valuable input into corridor planning, project development, project evaluation, and Long-Range Plan policy by providing data, system-level analysis, and strategy

¹⁷ Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission, *Congestion Management Process*, www.dvrpc.org/congestionmanagement/.

recommendations. The CMP also supports competitive grant programs such as the Congestion Mitigation and Air Quality (CMAQ) program and the setting and achievement of federal Transportation Performance Management (TPM) targets. The federally mandated supplemental strategy requirements are a key tool to help achieve *Update: Connections 2050* goals to expand travel options by building out a multimodal transportation network.

Proposed roadway network expansion projects must pass a screening for consistency with the CMP before moving on to more detailed review as part of the project evaluation and selection process. The proposed roadway expansion projects will only move forward if they are located in a CMP congested subcorridor area with capacity-adding identified as an appropriate strategy for that location. In short, the CMP helps the region make data-driven, multimodal investments to improve mobility and reduce congestion, reserving the use of roadway expansion as a last resort. A summary of the key findings from the *2023 CMP* is in *Appendix F—Financial Plan*.

Emergency Preparedness

The transportation network is one of the most important pieces of any emergency response. In Greater Philadelphia, DVRPC is not directly responsible for emergency preparedness, security, or evacuation planning efforts; this is handled at the state, county, and municipal levels. DVRPC does, however, embrace its role in

championing emergency preparedness and security by convening, collaborating, and coordinating with first responders.

Comprehensive Economic Development Strategy (CEDS)

The CEDS is the region's strategy-driven framework for diversifying the economy and increasing individual prosperity for the region's residents. Regions must update their CEDS at least every five years to qualify for U.S. Economic Development Administration (EDA) financial assistance.

DVRPC's 2024–2028 CEDS, *Growing Greater Philadelphia*, aims to help our economic development partners prioritize U.S. EDA economic development investments over the next five years.¹⁸ DVRPC staff work closely to ensure alignment of the Plan's vision, goals, and strategies with the CEDS, which covers topics such as business growth, workforce development, and economic resilience. Transportation projects evaluated for inclusion in the Long-Range Plan are scored in several ways based on their potential to increase the number of jobs that can be created, and do not score if there is risk for adverse impacts on economic vitality, such as barriers to local businesses during construction.

Regional Vision Zero

DVRPC and its partners are creating a safety action program to advance the region's Vision Zero by 2050 goal with a process designed to strengthen ongoing regional collaboration toward

¹⁸ Delaware Valley Regional Planning Commission, *Comprehensive Economic Development Strategy (2024–2028): Growing Greater Philadelphia*, DVRPC (Philadelphia, adopted September 2024), www.dvrpc.org/economic/ceds/.

eliminating crash fatalities and serious injuries. The *Regional Vision Zero (RVZ) Plan* will conform to USDOT criteria published in the Fiscal Year 2022 Safe Streets and Roads for All (SS4A) Notice of Funding Opportunity. In addition to required plan elements like a Regional High Injury Network, DVRPC also called on county and municipal partners to submit priority transportation plans and studies for consideration in the RVZ process to elevate local priorities and avoid duplication of effort. The RVZ process also hosted a summit of regional partners to promote collaboration in pursuit of shared safety goals and conducted a public engagement process using a crowdsourcing map tool, enabling members of the public to log safety concerns.

The City of Philadelphia's 2022 *Safety & Congestion Omnibus Action Plan* focuses on key strategies to improve road safety and reduce traffic congestion. The plan aims to:

- *Reduce speeding and reckless driving* through expanded camera-assisted traffic enforcement and policies that promote safer speeds.
- *Enhance transportation options* by strengthening alternatives to driving and expanding access to commuter benefits programs for employees of large companies.

- *Improve curb space management* by optimizing its use and encouraging sanitation and delivery activities during off-peak hours.
- *Regulate rideshare services more effectively* to ensure safe and efficient operations.
- In New Jersey, 2025 legislation ¹⁹ created the Target Zero Commission with the goal of eliminating traffic deaths and serious injuries in New Jersey by 2040. The 13-member group, which includes DVRPC representation, is directed to propose an action plan within one year of the bill's signing. These initiatives work together to create a safer, more efficient transportation network for all who live, work, learn, and play in the Greater Philadelphia region.

Megaregional Planning

Many planning issues extend beyond an MPO's boundary, such as transportation network expansion projects, sprawling development patterns, long commutes, congestion, extreme weather, air and water quality, electricity infrastructure, and transportation funding. DVRPC works with state DOTs and neighboring MPOs to identify cross-boundary issues. DVRPC then explores ways to address those issues, both formally and informally, through enhanced coordination and communication with the appropriate planning and operating agencies. These efforts are carried out under the auspices of the PennDOT

¹⁹ Governor of New Jersey, "Governor Murphy Signs Legislation Creating Target Zero Commission," State of New Jersey, January 13, 2025, accessed July 8, 2025, www.nj.gov/governor/news/news/562025/20250113a.shtml.

Planning Partners meetings, NJDOT MPO Coordination meetings, the Metropolitan Area Planning Forum (New York, New Jersey, and Connecticut MPOs), Mid-Atlantic Regional Planning Roundtable (Pennsylvania, New Jersey, Delaware, Maryland, and Virginia MPOs), and many more informal channels.

Plan Amendments

Between four-year updates, DVRPC may amend the Plan to reflect changes to an MRP's scope or the FFY timing for construction, or to add a new air quality significant project to the fiscally constrained financial plan in alignment with changes to the TIP. Amendments ensure the Plan remains aligned with the regional TIPs and state programs for Pennsylvania and New Jersey, while maintaining the funding status of projects in the DVRPC Board-adopted Plan. Cost changes to roadway expansion projects may also require analysis to ensure the Plan maintains the agreed-upon investment cap for that category. All air quality significant projects that are added to the funded Plan must undergo conformity analysis.

Three types of amendments may be considered, depending on the revision(s) to the project list:

Minor Amendment: Required when there is a change in scope, timing (FFY), funding status, or cost that results in an increase greater than 20 percent or \$10 million (whichever is larger) change to an existing MRP. Minor amendments can include creation of a new non-air quality significant MRP that occurs as a result of TIP adoption or new funding to the region. New

funding may include external or competitive funding programs. Minor amendments require a redetermination of fiscal constraint, but not a redetermination of air quality conformity. Public review occurs as part of the monthly TIP amendment process, which offers a public comment period on RTC and Board actions. Minor amendments are conducted as part of the TIP amendment process during monthly RTC and DVRPC Board meetings.

Major Amendment: Required for a new or existing MRP that is air quality significant when there is a change in scope, timing (FFY), funding status, or cost, when that cost increase is greater than 20 percent or \$10 million (whichever is larger). A new MRP may be created as a result of a TIP adoption or new funding to the region. New funding may include external or competitive funding programs. Major amendments require a redetermination of fiscal constraint and air quality conformity, and a 30-day public comment period. Up to one major amendment will be conducted per fiscal year, as needed, in coordination with annual air quality conformity analysis.

Administrative Modification: Where projects that are not air quality significant have a scope or timing (FFY) change that results in a less than 20 percent cost difference, an administrative modification is made internally, and the project is added or updated as part of the next regular Plan adoption. No public comment or conformity analysis is required.

If a planning partner—an agency or organization that collaborates with DVRPC on regional transportation and planning initiatives—requests an amendment between Plan

cycles for a project that does not otherwise meet the cost or scope change criteria for an automatic amendment, a major amendment should be handled following the process outlined in Table A-4. Some of the tasks in Table A-4 can be done concurrently, reducing the overall amount of time needed for an amendment to be completed.

MRP to TIP Process

An MRP must be funded in the Plan before it can be programmed in the TIP. The Funded Plan includes only MRPs that can move forward with available funding, while non-MRPs (projects under \$40 million that do not impact air quality) are tracked in the TIP. To determine if a TIP candidate project qualifies as an MRP, it must meet the cost threshold or impact regional travel patterns to the extent that it needs to be included in air quality conformity analysis. If it qualifies, the next step is to

verify if it is funded in the current Board-adopted Long-Range Plan. If funded on the Plan, the project moves forward in the TIP based on project readiness and funding availability. If not, it must first be funded in the Plan before being added to the TIP. A project can proceed with a concurrent Plan amendment, subject to approval from the relevant state DOT, transit agency, or other implementing body. Projects on the unfunded, aspirational list can only move into the TIP if nonregional funds are provided through competitive or discretionary funding or as part of a Plan amendment. Projects that do not meet the MRP definition can advance without additional requirements.

Projects included in the Vision Plan may receive letters of support from DVRPC for competitive funding opportunities. If awarded funding, project sponsors must secure any additional funds necessary to ensure full project implementation within a reasonable timeframe.

Table A-4: Major Amendment Process and Timeline

Step	Action	Time Required
Request	The sponsoring agency makes a formal request for a long-range plan amendment in written format. If the amendment is to an MRP, then the request should include project name, sponsor, scope, location, a mapped extent, need, construction or implementation timing (FFY), cost, project categories, and a map showing the completed facility alignment (if available).	• -
Data and Information Gathering	DVRPC staff and the sponsoring agency discuss the amendment request and address any outstanding questions or issues.	1–2 weeks
Project Evaluation	DVRPC staff will review financial plan implications with the RTC Financial Plan Subcommittee, and screen new project(s) using the Project Evaluation Criteria (adopted 2023).	1–2 weeks
Consultation	DVRPC staff, the sponsoring agency, and the RTC Financial Planning Subcommittee meet to recommend or not recommend the proposed amendment.	2–4 weeks
Documentation	DVRPC staff will develop documentation for the amendment that will be made available for public comment. This may require meeting any new mandatory federal requirements.	2–4 weeks
Air Quality Conformity	DVRPC staff will conduct air quality conformity analysis, if required, and coordinate with the Interagency Consultation Group.	6–8 weeks
Public Comment Period	The amendment will be posted on DVRPC’s website for public comments for 30 days. DVRPC will prepare a formal response to any written comment received, and comments will be considered in the version for Board adoption.	6–8 weeks
Committee and Board Adoption	The amendment will be brought to the RTC and DVRPC Board for adoption.	2–4 weeks

Source: DVRPC, 2025.

